

Fund Czechia + Spain

Condition release on a 90-day validation gate

The two-country option leads the defined base case and leaves room under both board caps. Approve a conditional EUR225,000 year-zero capex envelope for CZE and ESP, staffed at five FTE, with the second-stage release tied to verified volume, per-unit savings and local costs.

BASE ANNUAL GAIN

€198.1k

After EUR95k recurring fixed costs

YEAR-ZERO CAPEX

€225,000

50% of EUR450k cap

STAFFING

5 FTE

2 FTE below the seven-person cap

BASE SIMPLE PAYBACK

1.14 years

Stress payback: 6.99 years

WHY THIS OPTION

CZE+ESP produces EUR198.1k modeled annual contribution in the named base scenario, EUR11.8k above the next base-ranked POL+ESP pair, with EUR15k less capex and one fewer FTE. Its defined joint stress remains positive at EUR32.2k/year, but simple stress payback stretches to about seven years.

DECISION BASIS

Hard constraints: capex ≤ EUR450,000; ≤7 FTE; ≤2 hubs.
Consultant default: maximize base-case annual contribution, then disclose low/high/stress and payback. No scenario probabilities or board risk weights were supplied.

This is a conditional planning recommendation from synthetic client inputs, not a causal estimate of hub effects. Defer remains defensible if validation does not support the assumed uplift and savings.

2025 shipments support a €2.03m contribution pool

1,254 eligible shipments across six markets. All client order, return, unit-cost and fulfillment inputs are synthetic; no live customer system was accessed.

NET SALES

€4,383.8k

gross €4.465m less €80.8k refunds

CONTRIBUTION

€2,030.0k

46.3% of net sales

UNITS SHIPPED

77,436

1,081 units returned (1.4%)

ORDERS

1,254

209 in each synthetic market

Country	Orders	Units	Gross sales	Refunds	Net sales	Net COGS	Fulfillment	Contribution	Margin	Returns
DEU	209	12,153	€631,245	€5,453	€625,792	€349,980	€13,446	€262,366	41.9%	73
FRA	209	11,880	€640,930	€8,699	€632,231	€341,453	€14,507	€276,271	43.7%	144
NLD	209	12,576	€709,109	€11,376	€697,733	€365,496	€16,593	€315,644	45.2%	144
POL	209	13,163	€776,508	€14,618	€761,890	€386,698	€18,698	€356,494	46.8%	180
CZE	209	13,733	€834,572	€19,265	€815,307	€397,062	€20,910	€397,335	48.7%	288
ESP	209	13,931	€872,259	€21,420	€850,839	€406,230	€22,708	€421,900	49.6%	252
TOTAL	1,254	77,436	€4,464,622	€80,831	€4,383,792	€2,246,919	€106,862	€2,030,010	46.3%	1,081

Contribution by country



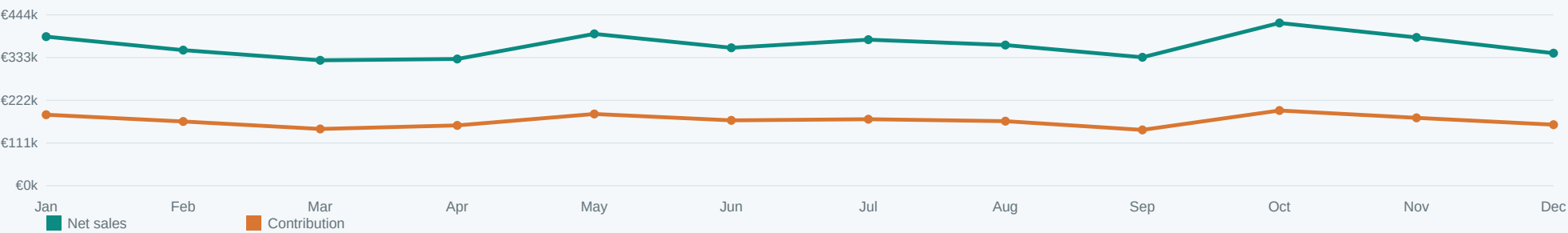
READOUT

Spain (€421.9k) and Czechia (€397.3k) contribute €819.2k, or 40.4% of total. Margins range 41.9%–49.6%. Each country has 209 eligible orders in this generated export; its ranking is not live demand evidence.

Monthly totals reconcile to country and order ledgers

Sales and refunds are converted using the original shipment month ECB mean; each per-order monetary component is rounded half-up to cents before summation.

Group monthly profile | EUR



Month	Orders	Units	Gross	Refunds	Net sales	Net COGS	Fulfillment	Contribution	Returned units
2025-01	108	6,734	€394,470	€6,698	€387,772	€193,754	€9,337	€184,682	90
2025-02	108	6,257	€359,440	€6,726	€352,714	€176,922	€8,695	€167,096	90
2025-03	102	6,023	€332,938	€6,728	€326,211	€170,174	€8,393	€147,644	90
2025-04	102	5,978	€336,357	€6,701	€329,656	€164,438	€8,306	€156,912	90
2025-05	108	6,772	€401,660	€6,712	€394,948	€199,056	€9,316	€186,575	90
2025-06	102	6,475	€365,514	€6,716	€358,798	€179,816	€8,934	€170,049	90
2025-07	108	6,726	€386,627	€6,731	€379,895	€197,753	€9,173	€172,969	90
2025-08	102	6,539	€372,651	€6,736	€365,915	€189,066	€8,947	€167,903	90
2025-09	102	6,077	€340,834	€6,748	€334,085	€180,493	€8,390	€145,202	90
2025-10	108	7,264	€430,073	€6,753	€423,320	€217,736	€9,934	€195,650	90
2025-11	108	6,617	€392,472	€6,762	€385,710	€199,987	€9,159	€176,564	90
2025-12	96	5,974	€351,587	€6,818	€344,768	€177,726	€8,278	€158,764	91

ACCOUNTING BRIDGE

Gross €4,464,622 – refunds €80,831 = net sales €4,383,792; net sales – net COGS €2,246,919 – fulfillment €106,862 = contribution €2,030,010.

RECONCILIATION / CUTOFF

All 9 requested fields reconcile across 72 monthly cells, six country totals and the order ledger. Returns include 2026-01-31; one later return is excluded and one orphan quarantined. Cash settlement data is absent.

Public macro series are context, not a demand proxy

Archived World Bank responses cover 2022–2024 for six markets. GDP is current US\$ (not PPP or constant-price); subsequent archive revisions may be reflected.

Market	Population 2024	Change 22–24	GDP pc 2022	GDP pc 2024	Change 22–24
Germany	83.52m	0.41%	\$50,507	\$56,104	11.1%
France	68.55m	0.54%	\$40,989	\$46,103	12.5%
Netherlands	17.99m	1.65%	\$59,123	\$67,465	14.1%
Poland	36.56m	-0.71%	\$18,891	\$25,104	32.9%
Czechia	10.91m	2.18%	\$28,282	\$31,828	12.5%
Spain	48.85m	2.22%	\$30,319	\$35,327	16.5%

INTERPRETATION

Population grew 2.22% in Spain and 2.18% in Czechia over 2022–2024; Poland declined 0.71%. Nominal GDP per capita rose in all markets, most in Poland (+32.9%). These series do not establish product demand or a hub effect.

ECB monthly arithmetic means | local currency units per EUR | 2025

Month	PLN / EUR	CZK / EUR	Published days / month
2025-01	4.246655	25.163318	22
2025-02	4.172225	25.076650	20
2025-03	4.182010	25.001238	21
2025-04	4.265220	25.038950	20
2025-05	4.253800	24.922857	21
2025-06	4.265771	24.804286	21
2025-07	4.254148	24.624609	23
2025-08	4.261305	24.516619	21
2025-09	4.258886	24.346773	22
2025-10	4.248791	24.315391	23
2025-11	4.237635	24.234050	20
2025-12	4.223857	24.259286	21

FX HANDLING

The supplied ECB reference rate is quoted as local-currency units per EUR. Conversion divides local amounts by the original shipment-month mean. EUR is 1 by convention. The reference-rate translation is an analytical assumption, not the customer's executed transaction rate.

World Bank archive last-updated metadata: 2026-07-13. Source-room retrieval: 2026-09-27. No live World Bank or ECB query was made for this analysis.

CZE + ESP ranks first on the stated base case

Annual incremental contribution after recurring fixed costs. Year-zero capex is separate. Scenarios use the client policy; pairs have no assumed synergy.

Option	Capex	FTE	Low €/yr	Base €/yr	High €/yr	Stress €/yr	Base PB	Stress PB
CZE + ESP	€225k	5	€64.6k	€198.1k	€331.6k	€32.2k	1.14	6.99
POL + ESP	€240k	6	€58.6k	€186.3k	€314.1k	€29.3k	1.29	8.20
POL + CZE	€205k	5	€56.9k	€179.0k	€301.1k	€-78.6k	1.15	—
NLD + ESP	€270k	6	€44.0k	€166.9k	€289.9k	€107.6k	1.62	2.51
NLD + CZE	€235k	5	€42.3k	€159.6k	€276.9k	€-0.2k	1.47	—
NLD + POL	€250k	6	€36.2k	€147.8k	€259.4k	€-3.1k	1.69	—
FRA + ESP	€340k	7	€13.7k	€129.8k	€246.0k	€73.1k	2.62	4.65
FRA + CZE	€305k	6	€12.0k	€122.5k	€233.1k	€-34.7k	2.49	—
FRA + POL	€320k	7	€5.9k	€110.7k	€215.6k	€-37.6k	2.89	—
DEU + CZE	€375k	7	€-2.5k	€105.5k	€213.5k	€-51.4k	3.56	—
ESP	€130k	3	€33.2k	€102.7k	€172.3k	€70.0k	1.27	1.86
CZE	€95k	2	€31.5k	€95.4k	€159.3k	€-37.8k	1.00	—
FRA + NLD	€350k	7	€-8.6k	€91.3k	€191.3k	€40.7k	3.83	8.60
POL	€110k	3	€25.4k	€83.6k	€141.8k	€-40.7k	1.32	—
NLD	€140k	3	€10.8k	€64.2k	€117.6k	€37.6k	2.18	3.72
FRA	€210k	4	€-19.5k	€27.1k	€73.7k	€3.1k	7.74	67.79
DEU	€280k	5	€-34.0k	€10.1k	€54.2k	€-13.6k	27.75	—
DEFER	€0k	0	€0.0k	€0.0k	€0.0k	€0.0k	—	—

Top base-case annual gain | €k



FEASIBILITY

17 hub sets: six singles and 11 pairs. Four DEU pairs fail a cap: DEU+FRA exceeds EUR450k; DEU+NLD/POL/ESP exceed seven FTE. CZE+ESP uses EUR225k and five FTE.

FORMULA

Low/base/high: $C \times u + U \times (1+u) \times \text{saving} - \text{fixed cost}$, with $u=10/25/40\%$. Stress: $(C-3\% \times G - \text{FX shock}) \times 1.25 - C + U \times 1.25 \times \text{saving} - \text{fixed}$. Capex is excluded from annual contribution.

Full pair-by-scenario paybacks and component assumptions are in the workbook and metrics.json. DEFER is zero contribution/capex/staffing.

Base-case leader gives up downside protection

No scenario probability or board risk weight was supplied. The recommendation uses base-case contribution as the explicit primary criterion and keeps stress visible.

Option	Low €/yr	Base €/yr	Stress €/yr	Capex	FTE	Base PB	Stress PB
CZE+ESP	€64.6k	€198.1k	€32.2k	€225k	5	1.14	6.99
POL+ESP	€58.6k	€186.3k	€29.3k	€240k	6	1.29	8.20
NLD+ESP	€44.0k	€166.9k	€107.6k	€270k	6	1.62	2.51

VS. NEXT BASE-RANKED: POL + ESP

CZE+ESP adds €11.8k/year in the base case, €6.1k in low and €17.5k in high; it also adds €2.9k/year under the defined stress. It needs €15k less capex, one fewer FTE, and its base payback is 1.14 vs 1.29 years. It is the stronger choice across the supplied scenario values and resource use.

VS. STRESS-RESILIENT: NLD + ESP

NLD+ESP earns €107.6k/year under stress vs €32.2k for CZE+ESP, but its base gain is €31.2k lower; it needs €45k more capex and one more FTE. Stress payback is 2.51 vs 6.99 years. A board prioritizing the defined joint stress over base-case return could select NLD+ESP.

CONCLUSION CARD | CONDITIONAL FUNDING RECOMMENDATION

Recommendation: authorize up to €225k and five FTE for CZE+ESP, with staged release after live operating validation. The base estimate is computed from the synthetic 2025 contribution pool and option assumptions; it is not causal proof.

Accepted risk: stress contribution is positive but simple stress payback is about seven years. Missing inputs: real site quotes, local operating costs, validated order density/uplift, observed savings, and a board risk preference. Reopen if these move the ranking or annual contribution below the low case.

Observable flip condition: holding ESP and all other inputs fixed, if CZE's actual uplift is below 22.2% while POL achieves 25%, POL+ESP overtakes on base annual contribution. Equivalent CZE savings threshold: about €1.41/unit at both sites' 25% uplift.

Defer condition: if day-90 validation cannot support the option's low-case economics, release no second-stage capex and return to the board. Scenarios are not probabilities and the joint stress is not a forecast.

Use 90 days to validate before committing irreversible spend

Owners below are proposed functional roles, not named Meridian personnel. The source room contains no live site quotes, contracts, interviews or operating SLA data.

DAYS 0–30

Validate the case

Owner: CFO / FP&A + Operations lead

Rebuild current demand baseline from live order and return records; validate option capex, fixed-cost and savings inputs; shortlist candidate locations; test CZE/ESP FX and labor assumptions.

Gate 1: refreshed CZE uplift and savings case remains ahead of POL+ESP; real quote fits EUR225k capex and EUR95k combined annual fixed costs.

DAYS 31–60

Design and contract

Owner: Procurement / Facilities + HR

Obtain site-specific quotations, lease terms, staffing availability and operating model; map inventory, replenishment, IT and return/restock workflow; stage contracts so either site can be stopped.

Gate 2: CFO and COO approve committed capex within envelope, five FTE plan, local compliance review and written service/stock process.

DAYS 61–90

Commission and prove

Owner: Regional Operations + Analytics

Activate first hub in a controlled pilot; open second only after the Gate 3 economics review; track country-level units, returns, savings, service and actual cost weekly.

Gate 3: continue only if annualized contribution after recurring cost is at least the low-case EUR64.6k and customer-promise performance is maintained.

WEEKLY KPI PLAN | PROVISIONAL GATE THRESHOLDS

VOLUME

≥1.25× validated 2025 run rate per market; measure shipped units/orders

SAVINGS

CZE ≥€2.10/unit; ESP ≥€3.00/unit, net of measured incremental handling

REFUNDS

Track refund EUR / gross sales; trigger review at baseline +3 percentage points

COST / SLA

Capex ≤€225k; recurring fixed ≤€95k; maintain ≥95% of quoted promise (set live baseline first)

A complete synthetic ledger, plus archived public context

The board should distinguish observed archived facts from synthetic client transactions and planning assumptions.

RECONCILED / RETAINED

- Orders: 1,328 raw rows across two pages + corrections; 13 exact duplicate rows removed; 18 order IDs revised, all latest revisions selected from corrections.
- Latest-order exclusions: 24 non-shipped; 18 tests; 1 shipped outside 2025. Kept 12 valid zero-gross shipped orders; 1,254 eligible orders remain.
- Returns: 20 duplicate rows removed; one revised return resolved by latest revision; 241 included, one orphan quarantined, one post-cutoff excluded.
- No selected latest-revision conflicts, negative gross orders, refund-above-gross orders, country/currency mismatches, missing unit costs or return quantities above shipped quantities detected.
- World Bank: 18 population + 18 GDP observations, 2022–24; missing values preserved (0 nulls in the archived payload). Source hashes: 14/14 match.

LIMITS THAT MATTER

- All client order, correction, return, unit-cost, hub-option and scenario inputs are synthetic (seed 2026092736). Their orderly 209-order/country pattern is not an observed demand distribution.
- Hub uplifts (10/25/40%), savings, fixed costs and capex are assumptions. No site-specific data, causal design, synergies, probability weights or board risk weights exist in the room.
- Payback is simple and undiscounted. It excludes ramp, taxes, financing, cash timing, residual value, leases beyond stated cost, working capital and other overhead.
- ECB rates are reference translation assumptions, not transaction prices. World Bank GDP per capita is current US\$ and not PPP or real income.

SOURCE REGISTER | URLs, retrieval times, hashes, units and periods also appear in analysis/source_register.csv and the workbook.

C1 Synthetic client data	data-dictionary.md; orders-part1.csv; orders-part2.csv; order-corrections.csv; returns.csv; unit-costs.csv; hub-options.csv; scenario-policy.md. Source room captured 2026-09-27 07:56 UTC. Files and hashes are saved under evidence/source_room/ http://127.0.0.1:52727/
P1 World Bank population	Archived API response; SP.POP.TOTL; persons, 2022–2024; last updated 2026-07-13; archive retrieved 2026-09-27 06:36 UTC. https://api.worldbank.org/v2/country/DEU;FRA;NLD;POL;CZE;ESP/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?date=2022:2024&format=json&per_page=1000
P2 World Bank GDP per capita	Archived API response; NY.GDP.PCAP.CD; current US dollars/person, 2022–2024; last updated 2026-07-13; archive retrieved 2026-09-27 06:36 UTC. https://api.worldbank.org/v2/country/DEU;FRA;NLD;POL;CZE;ESP/indicator/NY.GDP.PCAP.CD?date=2022:2024&format=json&per_page=1000
P3 ECB reference rates	Official euro foreign-exchange reference rates; local units per EUR; daily history; 255 observations in 2025; archive retrieved 2026-09-27 06:36 UTC. Monthly values average published days. https://www.ecb.europa.eu/stats/eurofxref/eurofxref-hist.zip

Raw inputs and scripts are saved locally. Source-room URLs are frozen collection provenance and may not resolve outside this disposable environment.